

New Testament





About the Course

Students read through the book of Acts over the year. Additional study helps assigned in the lesson plans provide background information and context to help students begin to dive deeper into the life, ministry, and message of the early church.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Bible: Grades 7-8



Placement & Combining Tips

Younger students in Grades 5-6 can be combined with older students if they have a good general understanding of the gospels. Ideal for HS students who are new to studying the Bible or unused to commentaries or discussions about cultural context or interpretive issues.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7-8	New Testament: Grades 7-8 1 time/week 30 min	The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition ESV Concise Study Bible Introducing the New Testament: A Historical, Literary, and Theological Survey

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Bible: Grades 7-8				
Old Testament: Grades 7-12	New Testament: Grades 7-8	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	Church History: Grades 7-9	Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

New Testament: Grades 7-8



The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition



ESV Concise Study Bible



Introducing the New Testament: A Historical, Literary, and Theological Survey



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

New Testament: Grades 7-8

∞ [Extra Helpings](#)

∞ [Video overviews of Bible books from Bible Project](#)

∞ [Teaching the Bible with Dr. John Walton](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Related Course Quick Links

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 6: Bible\)](#)

New Testament: Grades 7-8

How To Teach



Prepare

Read the commentary to prepare.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. Ask students to give a summary of what they remember. (Full narration is not necessary.)



Introduce

Use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to prepare students to receive the story. You may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

Read aloud from the Bible.



Narrate

Have the students narrate.



Share

Optional: Share something interesting from your preparation that will help shed light on the story.



Discuss

Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the story and any connections made.



Term 1

WEEK 1 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 1

Intro to Acts

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Introducing the New Testament, Notebook

Note: Introducing the New Testament is a resource book that will be used over 5 years. As students get older, they will read more sections and interact with some of the more scholarly questions about the New Testament. Only small sections will be read this year, but feel free to read more.

→ INTRO

1. The book of Acts is actually "part two" of the Gospel of Luke, but it has been put in its own section in the New Testament (following the four Gospels) because it is the only book that relates the history of the early church—what happened after the events reported in the Gospels.
2. Watch this short video about Acts with the author of the book, Introducing the New Testament.
∞ Video Link: Acts

→ READ & NARRATE

Introducing the New Testament

1. p.205-206 "The book of" - "Lord Jesus Christ."
2. In the video, the author asked you to pay attention to the key motifs that are outlined in the book of Acts. A motif is a dominant idea or central theme. Read about a couple of the motifs or major themes in Acts: p.216-220 "The book of" - "is worth remembering."

ESV Concise Study Bible

3. Although Luke is the author of two books in the New Testament, he is only mentioned three times in the Bible by name. Read the following verses to meet the author of the book of Acts: Col. 4:14; 2 Timothy 4:11; Philemon 24; Luke 1:1-4; Acts 1:1-5; Luke 24:36-53

→ NOTEBOOK

You read about five of the major themes in Acts. Write down each theme on the top line of 5 different pages in your notebook. Then write a brief sentence of what that theme means. As you read through Acts this year, you will add the events that fall under the different themes.

WEEK 2 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 2

Ascension

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Introducing the New Testament, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the book of Acts?

→ INTRO

Acts 1:8 is the key verse of Acts, and the outline of Acts follows this verse as the gospel spreads and the church grows. Jesus gives the disciples a job after he leaves them on earth to ascend to heaven. "The ascension is the conclusion of the synoptic Gospels, and it is the introduction to Acts, where it begins the story of the development of the church" (Bible Story Handbook, Walton).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Introducing the New Testament p.220-223 "The Jewish matrix" - "of his name."
Read about 3 more major themes in Acts. (You can skip Box 10.5.)



Term 1

2. ESV Concise Study Bible Acts 1:1-26

→ NOTEBOOK

Add the three additional themes you read about to your notebook and a brief sentence of explanation for each. Then record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant. There is not one right answer. For example, under the theme Centrality of Jerusalem, you can write: "Jesus orders his disciples not to leave Jerusalem."

WEEK 3 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 3

Pentecost

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

Acts 2 is considered the church's birthday. Luke shows how the Holy Spirit came upon all the believers there, and how they began speaking in other languages. This may bring to your mind the story from Genesis of the Tower of Babel. However, "[a]t the Tower of Babel, nobody could understand the languages, and it drove people apart. At Pentecost, the languages could be understood, and it brought people together into a unity that helped start the Church" (Bible Story Handbook).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 2:1-41
2. (Optional) Read notes in the ESV Study Bible.

- How does speaking different languages on the Day of Pentecost fit with the mission Jesus gave the disciples in Acts 1:8?

→ VIEW

Image Resource: Introducing the New Testament

Take a moment to look at the painting on p.211 (Fig. 10.1 Pentecost). Describe what you see in the painting.

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant. There is not one right answer. You may want to refer to Introducing the New Testament for extra guidance.